

Call me Ishmael; finding a damp, drizzly November in my soul, I take to the ship and set my course for the watery part of the world.



No, when I go to sea, I go as a simple sailor right before the mast, content to be ordered about and to be paid for it.



By reason of these things, I fixed on a whaling voyage—the great whale and the wild, distant seas swayed me, and the wonder-world swung open.